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Inventor(s)

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Connecting to remote access session based on proximity of mobile device

Abstract

The subject matter of this specification can be implemented in, among other things, a method that includes storing first client information identifying a first client device, identifying a location of the first client device, and identifying a first remote access session that provides the first client device access to resources of the remote access system. The method further includes receiving access information identifying an access device and a user account associated with the first client information. The access information indicates that the user account has been successfully authenticated by the access device. The method further includes, in response to the receipt of the access information, causing the first client device to connect to the first remote access session with the remote access system as a background process of the client device while a user interface of the client device remains locked.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/079,741 filed Dec. 12, 2022 which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,947,861; which itself claims the benefit of priority from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/566,237 filed Dec. 30, 2021 which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,537,355; which itself claims the benefit of priority from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/130,633 filed Dec. 22, 2020 which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,221,818; which itself claims the benefit of priority from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/776,262 filed Jan. 29, 2020, which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,175,878; which itself claims the benefit of priority from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/601,908 filed on May 22, 2017, which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,579,322; the entire contents of each being incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This instant specification relates to initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and to connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device.

BACKGROUND

(2) Remote access from one computing device to another may be provided, for example, by a terminal server or remote desktop virtualization. A terminal server allows a client computing device to connect to a server computing device over a network, such as a local area network (LAN) or the Internet. Often times, a terminal server allows the client computing device to access network server applications on the server computing device. The terminal server may allow the server computing device to be remotely controlled, monitored, or diagnosed by the client computing device over a telecommunications network.

(3) Remote desktop virtualization also operates in a client/server computing environment. Application execution takes place on a remote operating system which communicates with the local client device over a network using a remote display protocol through which the user interacts with applications. Generally, the applications and the data that are used remain on the remote system with only display, keyboard, and mouse information communicated with the local client device. In some cases, multiple desktop operating system instances are hosted on a server hardware platform running a hypervisor, where the desktop operating system instances being hosted may be instances of the same operating system as the remote operating system or instances of other operating systems.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram that shows an example of a system for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device.

(2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram that shows an example of a system for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device.

(3) FIG. 3 is flow chart that shows an example of a process for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote

access session based on proximity of a mobile device.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram that shows an example of a computing system.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) When a conventional client device is used to connect to a remote access session at a server device, a user must often wait after logging in to the client device to initiate and/or connect to the remote access session at the server device. This document describes systems and techniques for initiating a remote access session at a server device based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or connecting a client device to the remote access session at the server device based on proximity of a mobile device to the client device, which may allow the client device to complete the connection operation before a user of the mobile device logs onto to the client device.

(6) The mobile device may be carried, for example, by a person. The mobile device provides information identifying a geographical location of the mobile device to a remote access system. The remote access system determines whether the location of the mobile device is within a threshold distance from a client device that is associated with the mobile device and a remote access session. If so, the remote access system causes the client device to connect to the remote access session at a server device. The remote access session may be, for example, a terminal server session or a remote desktop virtualization session. The client device may communicate with the server device for the remote access session using, for example, a remote display protocol, such as the Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) or the Independent Computing Architecture (ICA) protocol. The person may then use the remote access session at the client device.

(7) Alternatively, or in addition, the remote access system may analyze a history of connections to the remote access session from the client device when the mobile device was within the threshold distance to determine days (e.g., days of the year, days of the month, and/or days of the week) and/or times of the day in which connections are made to the remote access session from the client device. The remote access system may then initiate the remote access session at the server device just prior to the days (e.g., days of the year, days of the month, and/or days of the week) and/or times of the day in which connections to the remote access session frequently occur from the client device.

(8) The systems and techniques described here may provide one or more of the following advantages. The remote access system may reduce an amount of time to provide a remote access session to a user of a client device by causing the client device to connect to the remote access session before the user accesses the client device. The remote access system may reduce an amount of time to provide a remote access session to a user of a client device by causing a server device to initiate the remote access session before the user accesses the client device. Conventionally, a remote access session that has been initiated at a server device causes the server device to use electricity. The server device may use electricity even when the client device has not yet connected to the remote access session and the remote access session is not being used. The remote access system may reduce an amount of energy or electricity used to provide a remote access session to a user of a client device by waiting to cause the server device to initiate the remote access session until a time when the user is likely to use the remote access session.

(9) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram that shows an example of a system **100** for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device **102**, such as a smartphone, a tablet device, or a smart watch. The mobile device **102** is in communication with a remote access system **104** over a network **106**, such as a local area network (LAN) or one or more of the computing devices that form the Internet. The remote access system **104** may include one or more computing devices that perform the operations of the remote access system **104**. The remote access system **104** causes a client device to connect to a remote access session when the mobile device **102** is in proximity to the client device. The mobile device **102** may be associated with a person or user. The remote access system **104** may also host and/or initiate the remote access session, for

example, at a day (e.g., day of the year, day of the month, and/or day of the week) and/or time of day prior to a day (e.g., day of the year, day of the month, and/or day of the week) and/or time of day at which the person is likely to connect to and use the remote access session at the client device.

(10) The remote access system **104** stores information that identifies locations of one or more client devices **108a-b** that are associated with the mobile device **102** and information that identifies remote access sessions that are associated with the client devices **108a-b** and/or the mobile device **102**. In some implementations, the information that identifies the locations of the client devices **108a-b** and the information that identifies the remote access sessions may be configured by a user of the mobile device **102**, the remote access system **104**, and/or the client devices **108a-b**. In some implementations, the remote access system **104** may determine the information that identifies the locations of the client devices **108a-b** and the information that identifies the remote access sessions by analyzing a historical record of connections to remote access sessions from the client devices **108a-b** and by correlating the record of connections with a historical record of locations provided by the mobile device **102**.

(11) For example, the first client device **108a** may be a computing device at a home of a user of the mobile device **102** and the second client device **108b** may be a computing device at a work office of the user. As the mobile device **102** is moved from one location to another, the mobile device **102** repeatedly identifies a location **110** of the mobile device **102** and provides information identifying the location **110** to the remote access system **104** over the network **106**. The remote access system **104** compares the location **110** of the mobile device **102** to the locations of the client devices **108a-b** to determine whether the mobile device **102** is located within one or more threshold distances **112a-c** from the client device **108a-b**. If the remote access system **104** determines that the location **110** of the mobile device **102** is within the threshold distance **112a** from the first client device **108a**, then the remote access system **104** sends a remote access command **114** to the first client device **108a** to cause the first client device **108a** to open a connection **116** to the remote access session that is associated with the first client device **108a** and/or the mobile device **102**. The remote access command **114** is a communication from a manager application at the remote access system **104** to a client application at the first client device **108a** that causes the client device **108a** to connect to the remote access session at a server device.

(12) The remote access session is in operation at the server device. The server device may include one or more computing devices that perform the operations of the server device. The server device may be included in the remote access system **104** or another system that is separate and/or distinct from the remote access system **104**. A server application at the server device initiates the remote access session. Initiating the remote access session may include, for example, executing boot-up and/or logon processes, such as running a script that automatically executes when the user logs in to the session, running applications from a folder designated as including applications to be automatically executed when the user logs in to the session, running services that automatically execute when the session starts and/or the user logs in to the session, and/or executing group policies or group policy preferences when the user logs in to the session. In some implementations, the server application initiates the remote access session in response to determining that the remote access session has not already been initiated and a request from one of the client devices **108a-b** to connect to the remote access session has been received.

(13) Alternatively, or in addition, the remote access system **104** and/or the mobile device **102** may store a record of days and/or times of day when the user has connected to the remote access session. The remote access system **104** and/or the mobile device **102** may then determine the days and/or times of day that the user is likely to connect to the remote access session. In response, the remote access system **104** and/or the mobile device **102** may then send a command to the server device to initiate the remote access session at some time prior to those days and/or times of day, such as five, ten, or twenty-five minutes before each of the days and/or times of day. The remote

access system **104** and/or the mobile device **102** may use an amount of time prior to the days and/or times of day that is enough time for the server device to perform the boot-up and/or login processes for the remote access session before the user is likely to connect to and/or use the remote access session. For example, the remote access system **104** and/or the mobile device **102** may determine how long the server device takes (e.g., an average of the times or the longest time) to initiate the remote access session and choose an amount of time before the days and/or times of day that is at least as long as the time the server device takes to initiate the remote access session.

(14) The remote access session is an instance of a user session or profile at the server device that may be accessed remotely at the client device **108a** by a client application that connects to the remote access session. The remote access session allows the client devices **108a-b** to access resources of the server device, such as volatile memory (e.g., random access memory), persistent memory (e.g., a hard drive), a processor (e.g., a central processing unit or a graphics processing unit), a component of an operating system, or an application. One or more of the resources may be physical resources that are accessed through the remote access session (e.g., through a terminal service). One or more of the resources may be virtual resources that accessed through the remote access session (e.g., through remote desktop virtualization). Once the remote access system **104** causes the first client device **108a** to connect to the remote access session, a user of the first client device **108a** may then use the remote access session to access the resources of the server device.

(15) The mobile device **102** may continue to provide the location **110** of the mobile device **102** to the remote access system **104**. For example, the remote access system **104** may compare the location **110** of the mobile device **102** to the locations of the client devices **108a-b** to determine that the mobile device **102** is no longer within the threshold distances **112a-b** from the client devices **108a-b**. The remote access system **104** may also determine that the first client device **108a** is still connected to the remote access session. In response to determining that the mobile device **102** is no longer within the threshold distance **112a** from the first client device **108a** and/or that the first client device **108a** is still connected to the remote access session, the remote access system **104** may send a remote access command to the first client device **108a** to cause the first client device **108a** to disconnect from the remote access session. Alternatively, the remote access system **104** may allow the first client device **108a** to remain connected to the remote access session until another client device (e.g., the second client device **108b**) connects to the same remote access session. For example, the remote access session may only allow one client device at a time to connect to the remote access session.

(16) The mobile device **102** may provide the location **110** of the mobile device **102** to the remote access system **104** again. The remote access system **104** may compare the location **110** of the mobile device **102** to the locations of the client devices **108a-b** to determine that the mobile device **102** is now within the threshold distance **112b** from the second client device **108b**. In response to determining that the mobile device **102** is within the threshold distance **112b** from the second client device **108b**, the remote access system **104** may send a remote access command to the second client device **108b** to cause the second client device **108b** to open a connection **118** to a remote access session. The remote access session that the remote access system **104** causes the second client device **108b** to connect to may be the same remote access session that the first client device **108a** was connected to or another remote access session that is separate and/or distinct from the remote access session that the first client device **108a** was connected to. The remote access system **104** may store information identifying a remote access session that is specific to the mobile device **102** and/or each particular client device that the mobile device **102** is within the threshold distance from. The remote access system **104** may use the stored information identifying the remote access sessions to determine which remote access session to cause a client device to connect to when the mobile device **102** is within the threshold distance from the client device.

(17) While shown as circular in FIG. 1, the threshold distances **112a-b** may be a shape other than circular. For example, the threshold distances **112a-b** may include coordinates of a polygon or

polyhedron around the client devices **108a-b**, respectively. While shown as two-dimensional in FIG. **1**, the threshold distances **112a-b** may be three-dimensional. For example, the locations of the mobile device **102** and the client devices **108a-b** may specify latitude, longitude, and elevation. The remote access system **104** may compare the latitude, longitude, and/or elevation from the location **110** of the mobile device to the latitude, longitude, and/or elevation for the client devices **108a-b** to determine whether the mobile device **102** is within the threshold distances **112a-b** of the client devices **108a-b**, respectively.

(18) In some implementations, the threshold distances **112a-b** may be chosen so that the client devices **108a-b** are able to connect to a respective remote access session before a user attempts to access the respective client device. For example, the threshold distances **112a-b** may be based on how often the client devices **108a-b** check for remote access commands from the remote access system **104**, how fast the mobile device **102** is able to travel to the client devices **108a-b**, and/or how long the client devices **108a-b** take to connect to the respective remote access session. The remote access system **104** may calculate the threshold distances **112a-b**. The remote access system **104** may expand a threshold distance if a user attempts to access a client device before the client device has finished connecting to the remote access session. The remote access system **104** may contract a threshold distance if a user routinely accesses a client device more than a threshold amount of time after the client device has finished connecting to the remote access session.

(19) In some implementations, the mobile device **102** may communicate with the network **106** through a wireless connection, such as a terrestrial wireless communication system (e.g., a cellular data network **120** or one or more Wi-Fi networks **122**) or a satellite system **124**. The mobile device **102** may determine the location **110** of the mobile device **102** by accessing a global positioning system, or by triangulation of or proximity to signals from one or more terrestrial antennas with known locations, such as cellular data network towers in the cellular data network **120** or Wi-Fi devices in the Wi-Fi networks **122**.

(20) FIG. **2** is a block diagram that shows an example of a system **200** for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device **202**. The system **200** includes the mobile device **202** and a client device **204** in communication with a remote access system **206** over a network **208**. The mobile device **202** includes one or more interfaces **210** to wirelessly communicate with the network **208**, such as interfaces to the cellular data network **120**, the Wi-Fi network **122**, and/or the satellite system **124**. The mobile device **202** includes a remote access manager client **212** that communicates with an operating system **214** of the mobile device **202**, for example, to determine a location **216** of the mobile device **202**. The operating system **214** of the mobile device **202** may use one or more of the global positioning system and/or terrestrial antennas to determine or approximate the location **216** of the mobile device **202**. The mobile device **202** provides the location **216** to the remote access system **206** over the network **208**.

(21) The remote access system **206** includes an interface **218** to communicate with the network **208**. The remote access system **206** also includes a remote access manager **220** that receives the location **216** from the mobile device **202** through the interface **218**. The remote access manager **220** includes a data storage **222** that stores information that identifies a location of the client device **204**, a threshold distance from the location of the client device **204**, and/or a remote access session associated with the client device **204** and/or the mobile device **202**. The remote access manager **220** compares the location **216** received from the mobile device **202** to the location of the client device **204** and the threshold distance from the data storage **222** to determine that the mobile device **202** is within the threshold distance from the client device **204**. In response, the remote access manager **220** sends a remote access command **224** to the client device **204** to initiate and/or connect to the remote access session associated with the client device **204** and/or the mobile device **202**.

(22) The client device **204** includes an interface **226** to communicate with the network **208**. The client device **204** also includes a remote access manager client **228** that receives the remote access

command **224** from the remote access system **206** through the interface **226**. In response, the remote access manager client **228** instructs a remote access client **230** at the client device **204** to open a connection **232** to a remote access session provided by a remote access server **234**.

(23) The remote access server **234** is hosted at a server device that may include one or more computing devices. The server device may be included in the remote access system **206** or a system that is separate and/or distinct from the remote access system **206**. The remote access manager **220** may cause the remote access server **234** to initiate a remote access session. Once connected, a user of the client device **204** may access resources provided by the server device through the connection **232** to the remote access session.

(24) In some implementations, the remote access manager client **212** at the mobile device **202** and/or the remote access manager client **228** at the client device **204** receive an input from a user, device, and/or application that includes manager authentication information, such as a username, password, and/or one-time password. The remote access manager client **212** and/or the remote access manager client **228** may provide the manager authentication information to the remote access manager **220**. The remote access manager **220** may condition the sending of the remote access command **224** on having successfully verified the manager authentication information received from the mobile device **202** and the client device **204** against corresponding authentication information that is stored at the remote access system **206** in the data storage **222** (e.g., a username and/or password) and/or calculated by the remote access manager **220** (e.g., a one-time password).

(25) In some implementations, the manager authentication information may include information from an access device at a particular location, such as a proximity card reader device or biometric reader device (e.g., an iris, fingerprint, or facial scanner) at a worksite. The mobile device **202** may communicate with the access device to determine whether the proximity card or biometric factor has been successfully read. The access device may provide information to the mobile device **202** regarding whether the card or factor has been successfully read. The mobile device **202** may provide the information to the remote access system **206**, for example, with the manager authentication information. Alternatively, the access device may provide the information regarding whether the card or factor has been successfully read to the remote access system **206**. The information provided to the remote access system **206** by the mobile device **202** and/or the access device may also include information that identifies a user account associated with the card and/or factor. The information provided to the remote access system **206** by the mobile device **202** and/or the access device may also include information that identifies the access device and/or the location of the access device. The user account may be associated with a remote access session at the remote access system **206**. The combination of the access device/location of the access device and the user account may be associated with the client device **204**. In some implementations, the remote access system **206** may initiate the remote access session at the remote access server **234** and/or cause the client device **204** to connect to the remote access session in response to receiving the information identifying the access device/location of the access device and the user account.

(26) In response to successfully verifying the received manager authentication information, the remote access manager **220** may perform a transformation on the received manager authentication information and/or additional information, such as by creating a hash of the information, to generate a key. The remote access manager **220** may provide the key to the remote access manager client **212** at the mobile device **202** and/or the remote access manager client **228** at the client device **204**. The remote access manager client **212** may store the key in a data storage **236** at the mobile device **202**. The remote access manager client **228** may store the key in a data storage **238** at the client device **204**. Alternatively, the remote access manager client **212** and/or the remote access manager client **228** may perform the transformation on the manager authentication information and/or additional information to generate the key and store the key in the data storage **236** and/or the data storage **238**, respectively. The remote access manager client **212** may provide the key and/or a reverse of the transformation of the key to the remote access system **206** with subsequent

instances of the location **216** of the mobile device **202** for authentication of the mobile device **202** by the remote access system **206**. The remote access manager client **228** may provide the key and/or a reverse of the transformation of the key to the remote access system **206** with subsequent checks for remote access commands for authentication of the client device **204** by the remote access system **206**. The communications between the mobile device **202**, the remote access system **206**, and/or the client device **204** over the network **208** may be encrypted.

(27) In some implementations, the manager authentication information used for authenticating the remote access manager client **228** at the client device **204** with the remote access manager **220** at the remote access system **206** is the same authentication information that is used to authenticate the remote access client **230** with the remote access server **234**. Alternatively, or in addition, server authentication information, such as a username, password, and/or one-time password, used to authenticate the remote access client **230** with the remote access server **234** may be separate and/or distinct from the manager authentication information used for authenticating the remote access manager client **228** with the remote access manager **220**. For example, the remote access client **230** at the client device **204** may receive an input from a user, device, and/or application that includes the server authentication information. The remote access client **230** may provide the authentication information to the remote access manager **220** and/or the remote access server **234**. The remote access server **234** may condition the initiation of the remote access session and/or the connection of the remote access client **230** to the remote access session provided by the remote access server **234** on having successfully verified the server authentication information received from the client device **204** against authentication information that is stored at the server device for the remote access server **234** (e.g., a user name and/or password) and/or calculated by the remote access server **234** (e.g., a one-time password).

(28) In response to successfully verifying the server authentication information received from the remote access client **230**, the remote access server **234** may perform a transformation on the received server authentication information and/or additional information, such as by creating a hash of the information, to generate a key. The remote access server **234** may provide the key to the remote access client **230** at the client device **204**. The remote access client **230** may store the key in the data storage **238** at the client device **204**. Alternatively, the remote access client **230** may perform the transformation on the authentication information and/or additional information to generate the key and store the key in the data storage **238**. The remote access client **230** may provide the key and/or a reverse of the transformation of the key to the remote access server **234** with subsequent requests for initiation of and/or connection to the remote access session for authentication of the client device **204** by the remote access server **234**.

(29) In response to the remote access manager client **228** receiving the remote access command **224**, the remote access manager client **228** may instruct the remote access client **230** to connect to the remote access session provided by the remote access server **234** in the background of a user profile for the client device **204** while a user interface of the client device **204** remains locked. A user may then provide authentication information to the client device **204** to unlock the user interface for the user profile where the remote access client **230** established the connection **232** to the remote access session.

(30) The remote access manager **220** may store the server authentication information received from the remote access client **230** and/or the remote access manager client **228** for initiating and/or connecting to the remote access server **234**. The server authentication information may include, for example, the username, password, and/or one-time password or the key and/or a reverse of the transformation of the key. In addition, the server authentication information may include an application specific password generated specifically for the remote access manager **220** and for initiating and/or connecting to the remote access session provided by the remote access server **234**. The remote access manager **220** may store the server authentication information in the data storage **222**. The remote access manager **220** may provide the server authentication information to the

remote access server **234** with a request to initiate the remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session.

(31) For example, the remote access manager **220** and/or the remote access server **234** may record and store information that identifies the days (e.g., days of the year, days of the month, and/or days of the week) and times of day at which the user connects to the remote access session. The remote access manager **220** and/or the remote access server **234** may also record and store information that identifies the applications the user accesses within the remote access session. The remote access manager **220** analyzes the stored information for the user to identify one or more days (e.g., days of the year, days of the month, and/or days of the week) and one or more times of day for those days at which the user connects to the remote access session. The remote access manager **220** may then use the stored server authentication information to authenticate with the remote access server **234** and send the request to initiate the remote access session at a time that is before the identified days and times of day. Alternatively, or in addition, for example if the server authentication information has not already been stored, the remote access manager **220** may send a request to the user at the mobile device **202** and/or the client device **204** for the server authentication information just before the time that is before the identified days and times of day. The remote access manager **220** may then use the server authentication information received from the mobile device **202** and/or the client device **204** to authenticate with the remote access server **234** and send the request to initiate the remote access session at the time that is before the identified days and times of day. The remote access manager **220** may also store the received server authentication information, for example, in the data storage **222** as previously described.

(32) The remote access manager **220** and/or the remote access server **234** may record and/or store information regarding the amount of time the remote access server **234** has historically taken to initiate the remote access session, such as the actual amounts of time, a rolling average of the amounts of time, and/or a maximum amount of time for a particular time period in the past. The remote access manager **220** may send the request to the remote access server **234** to initiate the remote access session at a time before the identified days and/or times of day that is at least the average or the maximum of the time the remote access server **234** historically takes to initiate the remote access session. Alternatively, or in addition, the remote access manager **220** may send the request to the remote access server **234** to initiate the remote access session at a time before the identified days and/or times of day that is at least a predetermined amount of time, such as five, ten, and/or twenty-five minutes.

(33) The remote access manager **220** may send a command to the remote access server **234** to disconnect from the remote access session, for example, once the remote access manager **220** has verified that the remote access server **234** has completed the initiation of the remote access session. The remote access manager **220** may cause the remote access server **234** to disconnect from the remote access session to allow the client device **204** to connect to the remote access session. The remote access manager **220** may also send a command to the remote access server **234** to log off and/or terminate the remote access session if the client device **204** does not connect to the remote access session within a threshold amount of time from the identified day and/or time of day for which the remote access session was initiated. Further, the remote access manager **220** may send a command to the remote access server **234** to log off and/or terminate the remote access session a threshold amount of time after the client device **204** disconnects from the remote access session.

(34) FIG. 3 is flow chart that shows an example of a process **300** for initiating a remote access session based on a history of connections to the remote access session and/or for connecting to the remote access session based on proximity of a mobile device. The process **300** may be performed, for example, by a system such as the system **100** and the system **200**. For clarity of presentation, the description that follows uses the system **100** and the system **200** as examples for describing the process **300**. However, another system, or combination of systems, may be used to perform the process **300**.

(35) The process **300** may begin, at block **302**, with identifying one or more remote access sessions connected to one or more client devices and locations of the client devices. For example, a remote access manager client at the first client device **108a** may report to the remote access system **104** that a remote access client at the first client device **108a** has connected to one or more instances of one or more remote access sessions at a server device and a remote access manager client at the second client device **108b** may report to the remote access system **104** that a remote access client at the second client device **108b** has connected to one or more instances of one or more remote access sessions at a server device.

(36) A remote access manager client at the mobile device **102** may provide locations of the mobile device **102** to the remote access system **104** at or near the times that the client devices **108a-b** connected to the instances of the remote access sessions. The remote access system **104** may then determine that times for ones of the locations of the mobile device **102** correspond to times for the connections to the instances of the remote access sessions. The remote access system **104** may associate a client device with a location of the mobile device **102** if a threshold number of times of locations provided by the mobile device **102** correspond to times of connections from the client device and the locations are within a threshold distance from one another. For example, the remote access system **104** may associate the first client device **108a** with an average of the locations of the mobile device **102** corresponding to times of a threshold number of connections from the first client device **108a** to the same remote access session. The remote access system **104** may also associate the mobile device **102** with the remote access session to which the first client device **108a** connected. Alternatively, or in addition, the remote access system **104** may receive one or more inputs from a user that manually specify the locations of one or more of the client devices **108a-b**. Alternatively, or in addition, the remote access system **104** may receive the locations of one or more of the client devices **108a-b** from the client devices **108a-b**, for example, using a Wi-Fi positioning system with locations of known Wi-Fi networks.

(37) In some implementations, the remote access system **104** may compare the days and/or the times of day of the locations for the same remote access session, client device, and/or mobile device to one another to determine that a threshold number of the days and/or the times of day are within a threshold range of a particular day and/or time of day. The comparison of the days may include comparing the days of the week of the remote access sessions for the user to determine that the threshold number of the days and/or times of day are within the threshold range from the particular day and/or time of day for a particular day of the week. The comparison of the days may include comparing the days (e.g., days of the year, days of the month, and/or days of the week) of the remote access sessions for the user to determine that the threshold number of the days and/or times of day are within the threshold range from the particular day and/or time of day for a particular day of the year. The remote access system **104** may then store a representation of the particular day and/or time of day and associate the particular day and/or time of day with the remote access session.

(38) At block **304**, the process **300** includes storing, in a memory, the identification of the remote access sessions and the corresponding locations of the client devices. For example, the remote access manager **220** may store the identification of the remote access session provided by the remote access server **234** for the client device **204** and the corresponding location of the client device **204** in the data storage **222**.

(39) At block **306**, the process **300** includes receiving an authentication for a user account from the mobile device and an authentication for the user account from a client device, where the remote access session is associated with the user account. For example, the remote access manager **220** at the remote access system **206** may receive authentication information for a user account from the remote access manager client **212** at the mobile device **202** and the remote access manager client **228** at the client device **204**.

(40) At block **308**, the process **300** includes determining whether a day and/or time of day for a

remote access session has occurred. If so, then the process **300** includes, at block **310**, causing a server device to initiate the remote access session. For example, the remote access manager **220** may store one or more times of day and days of week, month, or year for one or more remote access sessions to which the client device **204** connects. The client device **204** may connect to a first remote access session as early as eight o'clock in the morning on Monday when the mobile device **202** is present, but not until nine o'clock in the morning Tuesday through Friday. The client device **204** may connect to a second remote access session at noon on Saturday when a second mobile device is present. The remote access manager **220** may instruct the remote access server **234** to initiate the first remote access session each Monday some time before eight o'clock and each Tuesday through Friday some time before nine o'clock, such as five, ten, twenty, or thirty minutes before. The remote access manager **220** may instruct the remote access server **234** or another remote access server to initiate the second remote access session each Saturday some time before noon. Initiating a remote access session may include instantiating the remote access session at a server device so that the remote access session is ready to be connected to by a client device. In some implementations, the remote access manager **220** may randomly stagger the initiation of the remote access sessions to prevent too many remote access sessions from being initiated at the same time.

(41) At block **312**, the process **300** includes receiving, by an interface, information identifying a location of the mobile device. For example, the remote access manager **220** may receive the location **216** from the remote access manager client **212** at the mobile device **202**.

(42) At block **314**, the process **300** includes comparing, by a processing device, the received information identifying the location of the mobile device to the stored information identifying the locations of the client devices to determine whether the location of the mobile device is within a threshold distance from a location of one of the client devices. For example, the remote access manager **220** may compare the location **216** of the mobile device **202** to a location of the client device **204** that is stored in the data storage **222**.

(43) If the process **300** includes determining that the location of the mobile device is within the threshold distance from the location of one of the client devices, then the process **300** includes causing, at block **316**, the client device to connect to the remote access session at a server device. Causing the client device to connect to the remote access session may be further in response to the successful authentication of the mobile device and the client device. For example, the remote access manager **220** may send the remote access command **224** to the remote access manager client **228** to cause the remote access client **230** to open the connection **232** to the remote access session provided by the remote access server **234** in response to determining that the location **216** of the mobile device **202** is within the threshold distance from the location of the client device **204**.

(44) Otherwise, if the process **300** includes determining that the location of the mobile device is not within the threshold distance from the location of a client device and the client device previously connected to a remote access session, then the process **300** includes causing, at block **318**, the client device to disconnect from the remote access session. For example, if the remote access manager **220** determines that the location **216** of the mobile device **202** is no longer within the threshold distance from the client device **204**, then the remote access manager **220** may send a command to the remote access manager client **228** at the client device **204** to cause the remote access client **230** to disconnect from the remote access session.

(45) The process **300** may include returning to block **308**, where a determination of whether a time of day (and optionally a day of week) for a remote access session has occurred. The process **300** may also return to block **306** to receive an authentication from another mobile device and/or another client device.

(46) Not all illustrated acts may be required to implement the processes in accordance with the disclosed subject matter. For example, the process **300** may include initiating a remote access session by determining one or more remote access sessions, at block **302**; storing identification

information for the determined sessions, at block **304**; determining that a day and/or time of day for one of the determined remote access sessions has occurred, at block **308**; and, in response, causing the remote access session to be initiated, at block **310**. In another example, the process **300** may include causing a connection to a remote access session by storing information identifying locations of one or more client devices and information identifying one or more remote access sessions corresponding to the client devices, at block **304**; receiving information identifying a location of a mobile device, at block **312**; determining that the location of the mobile device is within a threshold distance from the location of one of the client devices, at block **314**; and, in response, causing the client device to connect to the remote access session at a server device, at block **316**.

(47) For simplicity of explanation, the processes of this disclosure are depicted and described as a series of acts. However, acts in accordance with this disclosure can occur in various orders and/or concurrently, and with other acts not presented and described herein. In addition, those skilled in the art will understand and appreciate that the processes could alternatively be represented as a series of interrelated states via a state diagram or events. Additionally, it should be appreciated that the processes disclosed in this specification are capable of being stored on an article of manufacture to facilitate transporting and transferring such processes to computing devices. The term “article of manufacture,” as used herein, is intended to encompass a computer program accessible from a computer-readable device or storage media.

(48) FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram that shows an example of a machine in the form of a computer system **400**. The computer system **400** executes one or more sets of instructions **426** that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein. The machine may operate in the capacity of a server or a client machine in client-server network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment. The machine may be a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a set-top box (STB), a personal digital assistant (PDA), a mobile telephone, a web appliance, a server, a network router, switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. Further, while only a single machine is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute the sets of instructions **426** to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(49) The computer system **400** includes a processor **402**, a main memory **404** (e.g., read-only memory (ROM), flash memory, dynamic random-access memory (DRAM) such as synchronous DRAM (SDRAM) or Rambus DRAM (RDRAM), etc.), a static memory **406** (e.g., flash memory, static random-access memory (SRAM), etc.), and a data storage device **416**, which communicate with each other via a bus **408**.

(50) The processor **402** represents one or more general-purpose processing devices such as a microprocessor, central processing unit, or the like. More particularly, the processor **402** may be a complex instruction set computing (CISC) microprocessor, reduced instruction set computing (RISC) microprocessor, very long instruction word (VLIW) microprocessor, or a processor implementing other instruction sets or processors implementing a combination of instruction sets. The processor **402** may also be one or more special-purpose processing devices such as an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), a digital signal processor (DSP), network processor, or the like. The processor **402** is configured to execute instructions of the remote access manager client **212**, the remote access manager **220**, the remote access server **234**, the remote access manager client **228**, and/or the remote access client **230** for performing the operations and steps discussed herein.

(51) The computer system **400** may further include a network interface device **422** that provides communication with other machines over a network **418**, such as a local area network (LAN), an intranet, an extranet, or the Internet. The computer system **400** also may include a display device **410** (e.g., a liquid crystal display (LCD) or a cathode ray tube (CRT)), an alphanumeric input

device **412** (e.g., a keyboard), a cursor control device **414** (e.g., a mouse), and a signal generation device **420** (e.g., a speaker).

(52) The data storage device **416** may include a computer-readable storage medium **424** on which is stored the sets of instructions **426** of the remote access manager client **212**, the remote access manager **220**, the remote access server **234**, the remote access manager client **228**, and/or the remote access client **230** embodying any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The sets of instructions **426** of the remote access manager client **212**, the remote access manager **220**, the remote access server **234**, the remote access manager client **228**, and/or the remote access client **230** may also reside, completely or at least partially, within the main memory **404** and/or within the processor **402** during execution thereof by the computer system **400**, the main memory **404** and the processor **402** also constituting computer-readable storage media. The sets of instructions **426** may further be transmitted or received over the network **418** via the network interface device **422**.

(53) While the example of the computer-readable storage medium **424** is shown as a single medium, the term “computer-readable storage medium” can include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) that store the sets of instructions **426**. The term “computer-readable storage medium” can include any medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies of the present disclosure. The term “computer-readable storage medium” can include, but not be limited to, solid-state memories, optical media, and magnetic media.

(54) In the foregoing description, numerous details are set forth. It will be apparent, however, to one of ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of this disclosure, that the present disclosure may be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form, rather than in detail, in order to avoid obscuring the present disclosure.

(55) Some portions of the detailed description have been presented in terms of algorithms and symbolic representations of operations on data bits within a computer memory. These algorithmic descriptions and representations are the means used by those skilled in the data processing arts to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. An algorithm is here, and generally, conceived to be a self-consistent sequence of steps leading to a desired result. The steps are those requiring physical manipulations of physical quantities. Usually, though not necessarily, these quantities take the form of electrical or magnetic signals capable of being stored, transferred, combined, compared, and otherwise manipulated. It has proven convenient at times, principally for reasons of common usage, to refer to these signals as bits, values, elements, symbols, characters, terms, numbers, or the like.

(56) It should be borne in mind, however, that all of these and similar terms are to be associated with the appropriate physical quantities and are merely convenient labels applied to these quantities. Unless specifically stated otherwise, it is appreciated that throughout the description, discussions utilizing terms such as “identifying”, “providing”, “enabling”, “finding”, “selecting” or the like, refer to the actions and processes of a computer system, or similar electronic computing device, that manipulates and transforms data represented as physical (e.g., electronic) quantities within the computer system memories or registers into other data similarly represented as physical quantities within the computer system memories or registers or other such information storage, transmission or display devices.

(57) The present disclosure also relates to an apparatus for performing the operations herein. This apparatus may be specially constructed for the required purposes, or it may comprise a general-purpose computer selectively activated or reconfigured by a computer program stored in the computer. Such a computer program may be stored in a computer readable storage medium, such as, but not limited to, any type of disk including a floppy disk, an optical disk, a compact disc read-

only memory (CD-ROM), a magnetic-optical disk, a read-only memory (ROM), a random access memory (RAM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), a magnetic or optical card, or any type of media suitable for storing electronic instructions.

(58) The words “example” or “exemplary” are used herein to mean serving as an example, instance, or illustration. Any aspect or design described herein as “example” or “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as preferred or advantageous over other aspects or designs. Rather, use of the words “example” or “exemplary” is intended to present concepts in a concrete fashion. As used in this application, the term “or” is intended to mean an inclusive “or” rather than an exclusive “or.” That is, unless specified otherwise, or clear from context, “X includes A or B” is intended to mean any of the natural inclusive permutations. That is, if X includes A; X includes B; or X includes both A and B, then “X includes A or B” is satisfied under any of the foregoing instances. In addition, the articles “a” and “an” as used in this application and the appended claims should generally be construed to mean “one or more” unless specified otherwise or clear from context to be directed to a singular form. Moreover, use of the term “an embodiment” or “one embodiment” or “an implementation” or “one implementation” throughout is not intended to mean the same embodiment or implementation unless described as such. The terms “first,” “second,” “third,” “fourth,” etc. as used herein are meant as labels to distinguish among different elements and may not necessarily have an ordinal meaning according to their numerical designation.

(59) It is to be understood that the above description is intended to be illustrative, and not restrictive. Other implementations will be apparent to those of skill in the art upon reading and understanding the above description. The scope of the disclosure should, therefore, be determined with reference to the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled.

(60) In situations in which the systems discussed here collect personal information about users, or may make use of personal information, the users may be provided with an opportunity to control whether the remote access manager client **212**, the remote access manager **220**, the remote access server **234**, the remote access manager client **228**, and/or the remote access client **230** collects user information (e.g., a user's current location). In addition, certain data may be treated in one or more ways before it is stored or used, so that personally identifiable information is removed. For example, a user's identity may be treated so that no personally identifiable information can be determined for the user, or a user's geographic location may be generalized where location information is obtained (such as to a city, ZIP code, or state level), so that a particular location of a user cannot be determined. Thus, the user may have control over how information is collected about the user and used by the remote access manager client **212**, the remote access manager **220**, the remote access server **234**, the remote access manager client **228**, and/or the remote access client **230**.

Claims

1. A method comprising: storing, in a memory accessible to a first client device, first client information identifying at least one of: first data relating to one or more target locations each identifying a location of a client device whilst a first remote access session providing the client device access to resources of a remote access system was established upon a successful authentication relating to the establishment of the first remote access session; and second data relating to one or more target days and times of day identifying a day and a time that the first remote access session providing the client device access to resources of the remote access system was established upon the successful authentication relating to the establishment of the first remote access session; and executing a process upon the first client device wherein an authentication of a second remote access session to provide access for the first client device to resources of the remote

access system is established in dependence upon: a positive determination of provisioning of correct credentials relating to the establishment of the second remote access session; a positive determination that a first condition with respect to a current date and time of day at which authenticating the establishment of the second remote access session occurs and the one or more target days and times of day has been met when the first client information comprises the first data; and a positive determination that a second condition with respect to a current location of the first client device when authenticating the establishment of the second remote access session occurs and the one or more target locations has been met when the first client information comprises the second data; wherein the current location of the first client device is established by at least one of: a current location of a mobile device which is associated with the first client device and established by the mobile device using one of a global positioning system and terrestrial antennas; and the first client device itself based upon a wireless positioning system using locations of known wireless networks; and each target location of the one or more target locations was established by at least one of: a location of a mobile device which is associated with the client device when the first remote access session was established and established by the mobile device using one of a global positioning system and terrestrial antennas; and the client device itself when the first remote access session was established based upon a wireless positioning system using locations of known wireless networks.

2. The method according to claim 1, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; and storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another; and the second data relating to the one or more target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data.

3. The method according to claim 1, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; and storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another; and the second data relating to the one or more target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data; and the client device and the first client device are each associated with a

user.

4. The method according to claim 1, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the first client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another; and the second data relating to the one or more target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data.

5. A method comprising: storing, in a memory accessible to a remote server, first client information identifying at least one of: first data relating to one or more target locations each identifying a location of a client device whilst a first remote access session providing the client device access to resources of a remote access system was established upon a successful authentication relating to the establishment of the first remote access session; and second data relating to one or more target days and times of day identifying a day and a time that the first remote access session providing the client device access to resources of the remote access system was established upon the successful authentication relating to the establishment of the first remote access session; and executing a process upon the remote server a process to initiate a second remote access session to provide access for a first client device to resources of the remote access system where the remote server initiates the second remote session in dependence upon: a positive determination that a first condition with respect to a current date and time of day at which authenticating the establishment of the second remote access session occurs and the one or more target days and times of day has been met when the first client information comprises the first data; wherein the current location of the first client device is established by at least one of: a current location of a mobile device which is associated with the first client device and established by the mobile device using one of a global positioning system and terrestrial antennas; and the first client device itself based upon a wireless positioning system using locations of known wireless networks; and each target location of the one or more target locations was established by at least one of: a location of a mobile device which is associated with the client device when the first remote access session was established and established by the mobile device using one of a global positioning system and terrestrial antennas; and the client device itself when the first remote access session was established based upon a wireless positioning system using location of known wireless networks.

6. The method according to claim 5, wherein the remote server initiates the second remote session in dependence upon: a positive determination that a second condition with respect to a current location of the first client device and the one or more target locations has been met when the first client information comprises the second data.

7. The method according to claim 5, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; and the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the

received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; and storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another.

8. The method according to claim 6, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; and the second data relating to the one or more target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data.

9. The method according to claim 5, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; and storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another; and the client device and the first client device are each associated with a user.

10. The method according to claim 6, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; and the second data relating to the one or more target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data; and the client device and the first client device are each associated with a user.

11. The method according to claim 5, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; and the first data relating to one or more target locations was established with a process comprising: receiving one or more locations of the first client device during a previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; comparing the received locations to one another to determine that the received locations are within a first threshold distance from one another for the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the compared received locations of the client device as part of the first data when the received locations are within the first threshold distance from one another.

12. The method according to claim 6, wherein the first remote access session is one of a series of previous remote access sessions where each previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions comprises a successful authentication to establish the previous remote access session of the series of remote access sessions; and the second data relating to the one or more

target days and times of day was established with another process comprising: establishing the day and time of day of each received one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions; storing a representation of the established days and times of day for the one or more locations of the client device during the previous remote session of the series of previous remote sessions as part of the second data.

13. The method according to claim 5, wherein the first condition with respect to a current date and time of day at which authenticating the establishment of the second remote access session occurs and one or more target days and times of day has been met when the first client information comprises the first data includes a time offset; and the time offset is established in dependence upon a measure of the time required to establish the second remote access session such that the initiation of the second remote access session is triggered ahead of one or more target days and times of day by the time offset.
